PARISHRAM 2.0

CLASS 12TH 2026

The Last Lesson (Flamingo)

ENGLISH LECTURE 02



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TOPICS TO BE COVERED

1 The Last Lesson

French language

Extreme detailed Summary


WELCOME TO OUR TEAM
English
Rocket Raccoon
YOU ARE GOING TO LOVE IT HERE!

Welcome

Can’t wait to see you

SHINE

in my Class!



In a Small village of Alsace, a French class marked for eternity...

Topic : The Last Lesson

📍 **About the Author:**

- Alphonse Daudet (1840–1897): French novelist and short story writer.
- Known for works reflecting realistic, emotional depictions of life in 19th-century France.
- "The Last Lesson" is a powerful story against the backdrop of Franco-Prussian War (1870–71).



Franco-Prussian ✓✓

↳ German empire.

France War

defeat 1870

Alsace
Al-zas

Lorraine
Luh-rayn

forced to speak German ✓.

Classroom

Topic : The Last Lesson

✨ BACKGROUND CONTEXT (Important to Begin With)

- **Historical Setting:** After France lost the Franco-Prussian War, Alsace and Lorraine were annexed by Prussia (now Germany).
- **New German Order:** German was to be imposed as the official language in schools.
- **Narrative Perspective:** First-person, narrated by a French schoolboy named Franz.
- The story captures the last French lesson in an Alsace classroom before German takes over.

Topic : The Last Lesson

✨ **Major Themes:**

- Loss of language = loss of identity
- Realization of value after loss
- Patriotism through education
- Regret and guilt
- Silent resistance



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1 Franz's Reluctant Start to the Day

scared to go to school

- Franz, a schoolboy, is late for school and dreading going.
- Why? He hadn't prepared his lesson on participles.



Mr. M Hamel

! "I started for school very late that morning and was in great dread of a scolding..."

fear

- He fears a scolding from M. Hamel, his teacher.
- His mind wanders—he's tempted to skip school and enjoy nature:

observe

attract

practice

- Birds chirping, Prussian soldiers drilling in the fields

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- "It was so warm, so bright!"
- "The birds were chirping at the edge of the woods; and in the open field back of the sawmill the Prussian soldiers were drilling."

forest

marching Practice

➡️ This contrast between natural joy vs. school duty sets the tone of regret.

He resisted the temptation

control

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2 Atmosphere on the Way to School

- On his way, Franz notices a crowd near the town hall bulletin-board. (notice board)
- It was the usual place for bad news: war, conscription, orders. (commands of the officer)
- He sees blacksmith Wachter calling out: (लोहार) (with his helper) (lost battle)

! ("Don't go so fast, bub; you'll get to your school in plenty of time!") ★ Imp

(Bub- child | kid | boy)



➡ Wachter's words sound strange—Franz is confused but continues.

watcher's lines – out of concern

Franz interpretation → watcher is making fun of him

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school was as quite as Sunday morning

3 Unusual Calm at School

- Usually, school was noisy—students reciting, desks creaking, teacher's ruler tapping.
- Today, the atmosphere is strangely quiet.
- Franz slips in, embarrassed, expecting punishment. But...



everybody is seated

Mr. M Hamel in class.

! "To my great surprise M. Hamel said very kindly, 'Go to your place quickly, little Franz. We were beginning without you.'"

→ confused

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➡️ This kindness shocks him—marks a shift in tone



Topic : The Last Lesson

4 Franz Observes the Class Carefully

- He notices things he never paid attention to before:
- Clean classroom
- M. Hamel in formal green coat, frilled shirt— only worn on inspection or prize days.
- Elderly villagers sitting on back benches:
- Old Hauser, the former mayor, former postmaster, others.



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❗ "They were all looking sad and Hauser had brought an old primer, thumbing the pages with his big glasses."

↳ book

➡️ Villagers came to show respect and repent for not valuing their language.

↳ regret



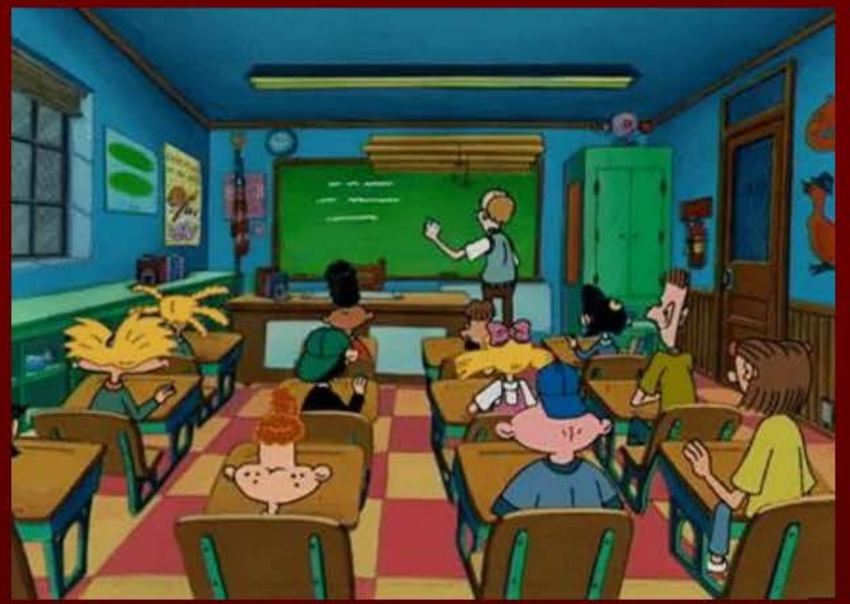
Topic : The Last Lesson

5 M. Hamel Breaks the News

- M. Hamel announces that this is the last French lesson.

! "My children, this is the last lesson I shall give you."

! "The order has come from Berlin to teach only German in the schools of Alsace and Lorraine."



→ Shocked

Shocking news

↑

☆ "what a thunderclap it was to me"

- Franz is shocked—now regrets not studying, skipping school.

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! "Oh, the sorrow of it!"

instant regret

➡ The moment marks a personal and cultural awakening. ✓ realisation

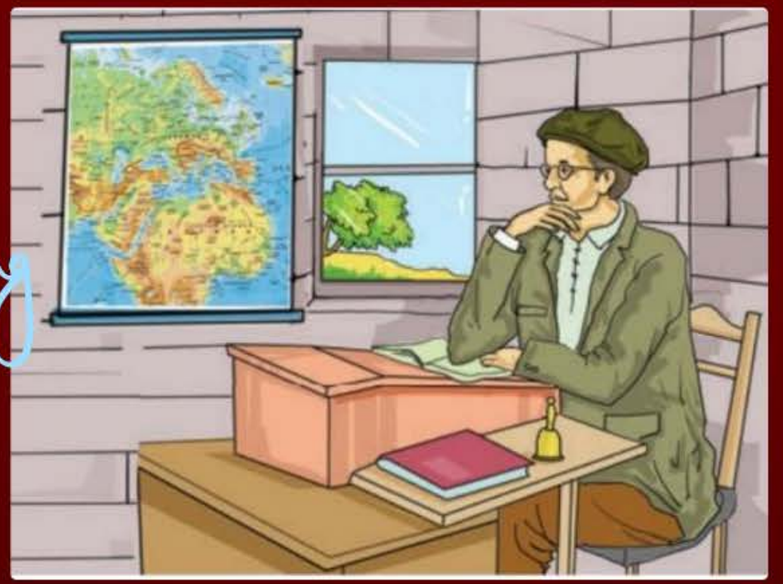


Franz compared his books to old friends ✓ that may not be there but still unforgettable ✓

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6 M. Hamel's Emotional Address

- He addresses the students and villagers with deep emotion.
- Blames:
- Parents for sending children to farms and mills instead of school.
- Children for being careless and lazy.
- His own teaching—he sometimes gave them holidays.



He made a mistake while speaking
he felt bad

asked all the students to recite something in french

Extra money

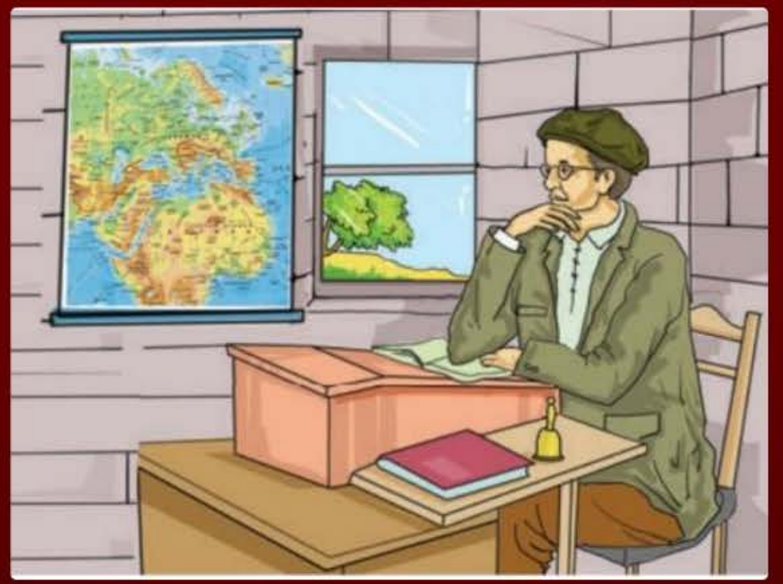
water plants

Habit of Procrastination → to delay actions

! ("We've all a great deal to reproach ourselves → tough time ahead.
have
to face
with.")

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➡ Acknowledges collective guilt and loss of national pride.



Topic : The Last Lesson

8 Grammar and Writing Practice

- M. Hamel teaches grammar, and Franz listens carefully—for once, really understanding.
- The writing lesson is done on new copies written in beautiful round handwriting

! "France, Alsace, France, Alsace..."



Surprised

Extra effort

dedicated teacher

Little flags floating in class

French - Most logical, clearest and beautiful language of the world

↓

His way of tribute

"As long as we hold fast to our language it is as if the key to your prison"

Know

↓

कैद

language - pride / identity

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lessons

➡️ The ~~repetition of~~ ~~words~~ signifies deep national longing and fading identity.

- Everyone is engrossed: busy (with small children
- Even Hauser trembles, spelling with effort. crying
- The whole room feels frozen in time, captured in the sacredness of the moment.

name

Crackup laughing | crying

Mixed emotions



Class atmosphere ↓ Serious/ solemn

He hear pigeons cooing on the roof.

"Are the germans going to make them sing in german?

↓

Sarcastic comment on germans

They cannot control nature

You can only control something that you feel is inferior

कम

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9 Final Reading – History Lesson

- M. Hamel reads history.
- Franz reflects how everything in the classroom feels so familiar yet about to disappear:
- Desk, trees, garden, school building—suddenly precious.

Mr. M. Hamel was observing everything → nostalgic → capture the memories

❗ "How well I remembered it all!"

Teacher taught - 40 years

leave the country

➡️ Realization hits him hard—they're losing not just a lesson, but a whole way of life.



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🔟 The Clock Strikes Twelve

- The church clock chimes twelve.
- Prussians march in.
- M. Hamel tries to speak but is overwhelmed with emotion.



❗ "He tried to say something, but something choked him."

- He goes to the blackboard and writes in huge letters:

❗ "Vive La France!" (Long live France)

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➡️ His final act is silent resistance—a tribute to the endurance of French identity.

- He gestures to dismiss the class.

❗ "School is dismissed—you may go."



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🔍 IMPORTANT LINES FOR EXAM USE (Add to Boards, PPTs)

1. “What a thunderclap these words were to me!”
2. “We’ve all a great deal to reproach ourselves with.”
3. “Your French lesson—don’t forget it.”
4. “Vive La France!”
5. “When people are enslaved… it is as if they had the key to their prison.”

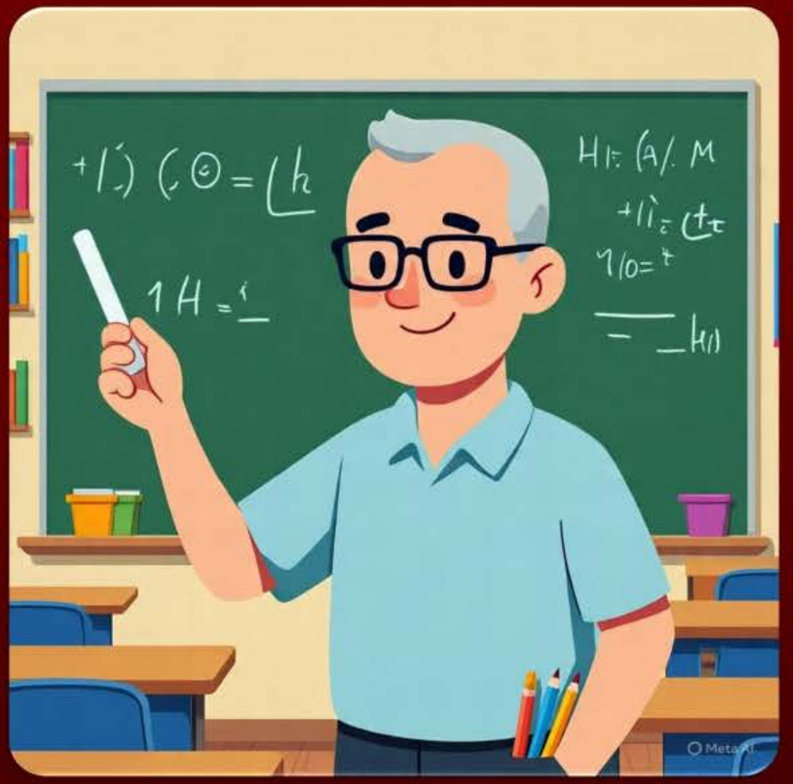


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🧠 CHARACTER ANALYSIS

👦 Franz:

- Young, naive, initially careless.
- Symbolizes the youth of Alsace who took their identity for granted.
- By the end: regretful, aware, emotionally transformed.



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👨‍🏫 **M. Hamel:**

- Strict, patriotic, deeply emotional.
- Symbol of linguistic and national pride.
- In his last lesson, becomes more than a teacher—a guardian of culture.



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👵 Villagers:

- Represent collective guilt and solidarity.
- Even though they didn't value learning before, they now come in respect.



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💭 THEMES EXPLAINED IN BRIEF

💔 **Loss of Language**	Losing French symbolizes losing one's identity and culture.
⏰ **Realization After Loss**	Franz and others understand the value of language only when it's too late.
FR **Patriotism and Resistance**	M. Hamel's behavior and "Vive La France" show subtle defiance.
🧍 **Guilt and Regret**	Everyone regrets ignoring education.
📚 **Importance of Education**	The story conveys how vital education is to national consciousness.

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🎭 SYMBOLISM and DEVICES

Device	Example	Interpretation
Irony	Students now want to learn—but it's too late	Highlights negligence and lost opportunities
Symbolism	"Vive La France!"	Represents undying patriotism
Personification	School building, desks, garden	Emphasizes emotional connection to setting
Contrast	Quiet class vs. usual noise	Reflects solemnity of the day
First-person POV	Franz's narration	Helps reader experience emotional transformation

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📌 **CONCLUDING POINTS TO EMPHASIZE WHILE TEACHING:**

- This is not just about language—it's about losing one's soul under oppression.
- The title "The Last Lesson" carries weight—not just a lesson in grammar but in history, pride, regret, and patriotism.
- M. Hamel, with his dignity and love for language, becomes an iconic figure of silent resistance.



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Narrator's failure and the teacher's response

- Franz asked to recite the rule for participle
- wished that he was able to recite the rules flawlessly
- feels guilty on getting everything mixed up
- M. Hamel does not scold Franz
- comments upon man's nature of postponing things
- makes the students realise the irony of not being able to speak or write French in spite of being a Frenchman



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Lack of learning: Hamel's view

- parents ignorant; not anxious to have their children learn
- children preferred to be put to work on farms or mills
- also blamed himself for sending children on errands for his convenience



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M. Hamel's startling revelation

- M. Hamel demanded full attention and announced that it was to be their last lesson in French
- had received orders from Berlin to teach only German in schools of Alsace and Lorraine
- new teacher was going to join the next day



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A grim realisation dawns on the narrator

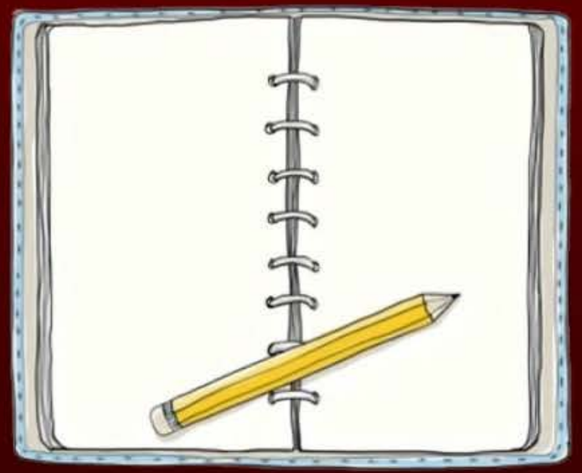
- realised that he had so much more yet to learn
- felt sorry for whiling away his time and skipping his lessons
- now did not want to part with his books of grammar and history, which he had earlier considered a nuisance
- deeply pained at the thought of M. Hamel going away
- forgot all about the teacher's ruler and his cranky Nature.
- realised that M. Hamel had worn his fine Sunday clothes in honour of the last lesson.



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A tribute by the villagers

- villagers gathered in the classroom:
- as a sign of repentance for not having gone to school more often
- to thank their master for his meritorious service of forty years
- as a mark of respect for the country which was no longer theirs



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Usual scene at school

- began with a great bustle
- noise of opening and closing of desks
- lessons repeated loudly in unison
- teacher's ruler striking hard against the table



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Changed scenario that day

- everything very still and as quiet as Sunday morning
- all classmates already in their places
- M. Hamel pacing up and down with the ruler under his arm
- Franz frightened to enter



Topic : The Last Lesson

The classroom surprises Franz

- M. Hamel unexpectedly kind
- had put on his beautiful green coat, frilled shirt and an embroidered black
- silk cap which he normally wore only on inspection and prize days
- entire school wore a strange and serious look
- strangely enough, back benches occupied by the village people



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Franz's fears while going to school

- late for school
- dreads teacher's scolding
- had not learnt his lesson on participles
- thinks of running away & spending the day outside as:
- the day was warm & bright with birds chirping
- he was tempted to watch the Prussian soldiers drilling
- overcomes temptations and hurries to school



Topic : The Last Lesson

Scene at the town hall

- a crowd in front of the bulletin-board
- it was source of all bad news: the lost battles, the draft, the orders of the commanding officer
- Franz worries what the matter could be
- astounded by the blacksmith's remark that there was plenty of time to reach school

QUESTION

#Q. What was Franz banking on to enter the class as he was late?

depending

1. M. Hamel's teaching on the blackboard
2. commotion in the class ✓
3. Hauser helping him sneak in
4. to quietly walk in when everyone was preoccupied with participles



QUESTION

#Q. What does M. Hamel's motionless posture reflect?



1. The school is dismissed ✗
2. Sense of finality ✓ — last moment
3. Changing order of life ✗
4. Feeling of nostalgia → sadness when he was sitting and observing.

QUESTION

#Q. What is the moral that the Alphonse Daudet wants to bring out?



1. Not to put off things that one can do that day
2. Old order changed to new
3. One should accept everything that happens
4. Teachers should be respected

QUESTION

#Q. Why did Hamel blame himself?

1. Not having taught them enough french
2. Not being strict
3. Giving students a holiday at times
4. Not being responsible

bookish reason
notes reason

(3)



QUESTION

#Q. Who sat on the back bench on the last lesson?



1. Franz
2. Prussians
3. the village people
4. The new teacher

QUESTION

#Q. What was M. Hamel going to question Franz about?

1. Participles ✓ (A)
2. Adjectives
3. Old primer
4. Ba be bi bo bu

(A)



QUESTION

#Q. What did Mr. Hamel bring for his class on his last day in the school?



1. New pens
2. New notebooks
3. Sweets
4. Story books

QUESTION

#Q. What was Franz expected to be prepared for at school that day?



1. Song
2. Dance
3. Essay writing
4. Participles

QUESTION

#Q. Why did the villagers come to meet M. Hamel in the school?



1. To complain
2. To say goodbye
3. To gossip
4. To show gratitude

QUESTION

#Q. Why was Franz surprised? when he entered the class

1. Because of village elders
2. Because of police patrolling
3. Because of students' behavior
4. Because of M. Hamel's kind and polite behaviour ✓



(4)

QUESTION

#Q. What did Franz find on reaching the school?

1. People were dancing
2. School was closed
3. Police patrolling
4. Strange quietness



QUESTION

#Q. The story 'The Last Lesson' highlights which human tendency?



1. Male Chauvinism
2. Procrastination
3. Courage
4. Cowardice

QUESTION



#Q. What was the mood in the classroom when M Hamel gave his last French lesson?

Ans. The order from Berlin stated that only German will be taught in the schools of Alsace and Lorraine. The order effected many changes, as an unusual silence prevailed in the school, compared to the hustle and bustle earlier. M Hamel became soft in speaking to the students, while the people realised the importance of their language. The villagers even attended the school to show respect to M Hamel. and give tribute to French language

QUESTION

#Q. Franz didn't learn French, whom did M. Hamel blame?

Ans. M. Hamel didn't blame Franz for not learning but his parents who were not anxious to have him learn. Instead they wanted him to work on a farm or at the mill to earn money. Even he blamed himself for sending him to water the flowers instead of learning and for declaring holiday when he wanted to go fishing.

QUESTION

#Q. What was the news which was put up on the bulletin board?

Ans. For the last two years all bad news – the lost battles, the orders of the commanding officer was displayed on the notice board. That day, the news that only German would be taught in school of Alsace and Lorraine was displayed on the notice-board which made the crowd gather there to read it.

QUESTION

#Q. What did Franz notice that was unusual about the school that day?

Ans. Franz noticed the absence of the routine hustle and bustle caused by the opening and closing of desks, repeating of the lessons and rapping of the teacher's ruler on the table. The usual hustle – bustle was replaced by a strange stillness that was the characteristic of a school on a Sunday morning.

QUESTION

#Q. What happened when the church clock struck twelve?

Ans. The moment the church clock struck twelve, they started prayer in the church and the trumpet of Prussian soldiers returning from the drill sounded under their window. M. Hamel stood up and tried to speak but his voice was choked. He gathered his strength and wrote on the black board as large as he could Vive La France and dismissed the school.



QUESTION

#Q. What was more tempting to Franz rather than going to school?

Ans. Since Franz was not prepared with participles and was late for the school, he found warm and bright weather with birds songs and Prussian soldiers drill much more tempting than going to school.

QUESTION

#Q. What changes did the order from Berlin cause in school that day?

Ans. The order from Berlin brought to a standstill, all the routine hustle-bustle of school life. M. Hamel taught his lessons with patience and became more sympathetic to his students. The students became more attentive in their classes. The villagers, who were sitting as usual at the empty back benches had come to show their respect and gratitude to M. Hamel, and regretted not going to school more often.

QUESTION

#Q. What did M. Hamel say about the French language?

Ans. He said that it is the most beautiful language in the world, the clearest, and the most logical. He requested them to guard it so that they could be united and fight back for their freedom.

QUESTION

#Q. What was the narrator's greatest fear as he moved towards the school?

Ans. Franz had started late for school that day and was afraid of being scolded. His fear gripped him further for he was also unprepared. He had not learnt the rules of participles as instructed by his teacher, thus dreaded the teacher's anger.

QUESTION

#Q. How did M Hamel say farewell to his students and the people of the town?

Ans. At the end of his 'Last Lesson', M Hamel stood up to say farewell to his students and the people of the town. He tried to speak, but overwhelming emotion choked his voice. He then wrote as large as he could on the blackboard 'Vive La France'; then he dismissed the class with a gesture with his hand.

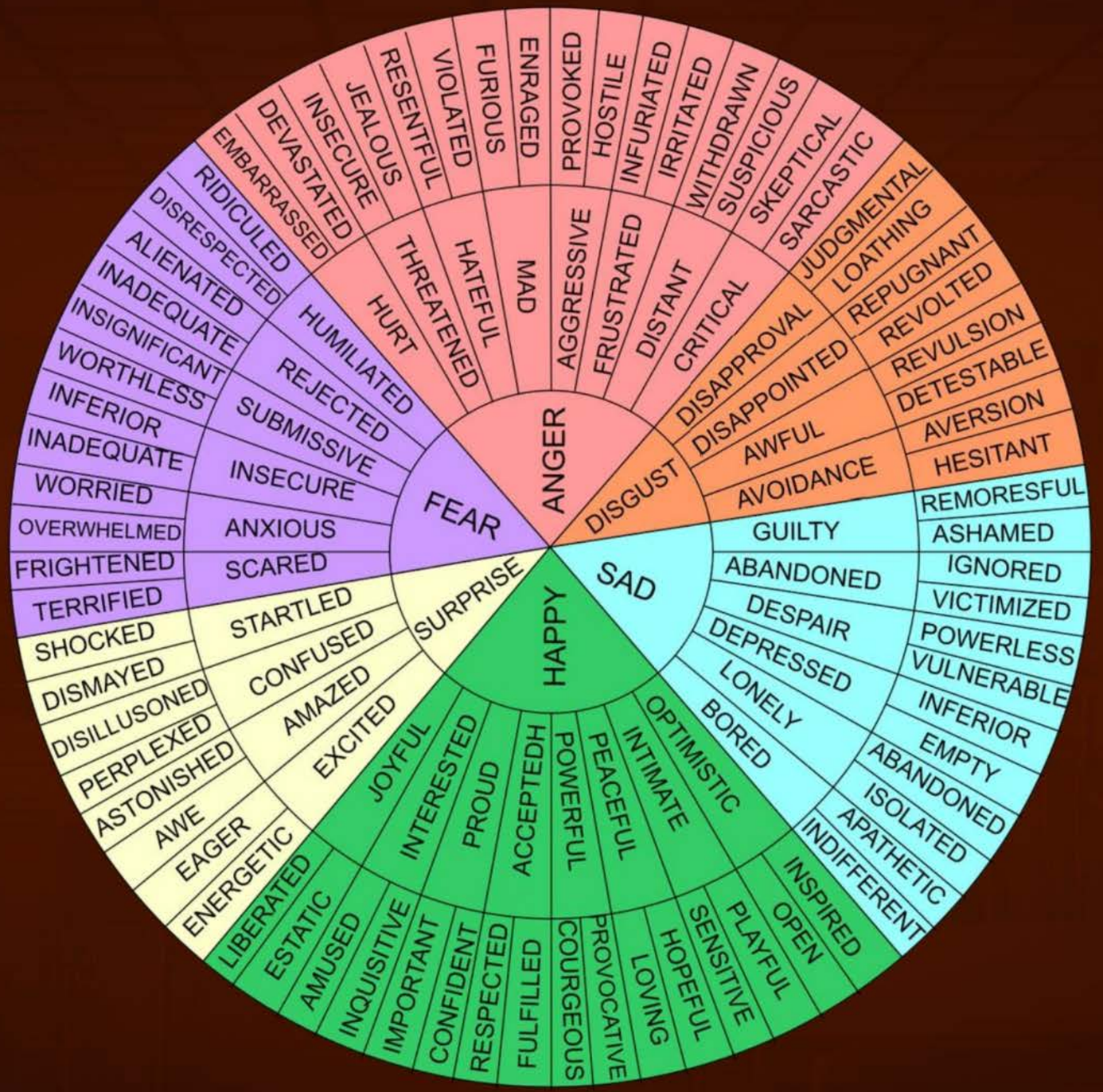
QUESTION

#Q. What made M Hamel ~~cry~~ feel overwhelmed towards the end of his last lesson?

Ans. M Hamel had taught French at the school for the last forty years. He was emotionally attached to the school and everything in and about it. He was really heartbroken to leave it all. Besides, his own predicament reminded him that his country would soon lose its independence. All this made him cry towards the end of his last lesson.

idea


did you Enjoy the class
Yes
No.
95.06.1.
BYE, BYE.


ANGER
HURT
EMBARRASSED
DEVASTATED
INSECURE
JEALOUS
RESENTFUL
VIOLATED
FURIOUS
ENRAGED
THREATENED
RIDICULED
DISRESPECTED
ALIENATED
HATEFUL
PROVOKED
HOSTILE
INFURIATED
IRRITATED
WITHDRAWN
SUSPICIOUS
SKEPTICAL
SARCASTIC
MAD
HUMILIATED
REJECTED
SUBMISSIVE
AGGRESSIVE
FRUSTRATED
DISTANT
CRITICAL
JUDGMENTAL
LOATHING
REPUGNANT
REVOLTED
REVULSION
DETESTABLE
AVERSION
HESITANT
FEAR
INADEQUATE
INSIGNIFICANT
WORTHLESS
INFERIOR
INADEQUATE
WORRIED
OVERWHELMED
FRIGHTENED
TERRIFIED
INSECURE
ANXIOUS
SCARED
DISGUST
DISAPPROVAL
DISAPPOINTED
AWFUL
AVOIDANCE
SURPRISE
STARTLED
CONFUSED
AMAZED
EXCITED
SHOCKED
DISMAYED
DISILLUSONED
PERPLEXED
ASTONISHED
AWE
EAGER
ENERGETIC
SAD
GUILTY
ABANDONED
DESPAIR
DEPRESSED
LONELY
BORED
REMORESFUL
ASHAMED
IGNORED
VICTIMIZED
POWERLESS
VULNERABLE
INFERIOR
EMPTY
ABANDONED
ISOLATED
APATHETIC
INDIFFERENT
HAPPY
JOYFUL
INTERESTED
PROUD
ACCEPTEDH
POWERFUL
PEACEFUL
INTIMATE
OPTIMISTIC
INSPIRED
OPEN
PLAYFUL
SENSITIVE
HOPEFUL
LOVING
PROVOCATIVE
COURGEOUS
FULFILLED
RESPECTED
CONFIDENT
IMPORTANT
INQUISITIVE
AMUSED
ESTATIC
LIBERATED

THANK YOU